

ANACHRON

The nineties never left.
They moved into your browser.

VOL. 95
THE GUIDE



nomnao.github.io/anachron

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PIGEON



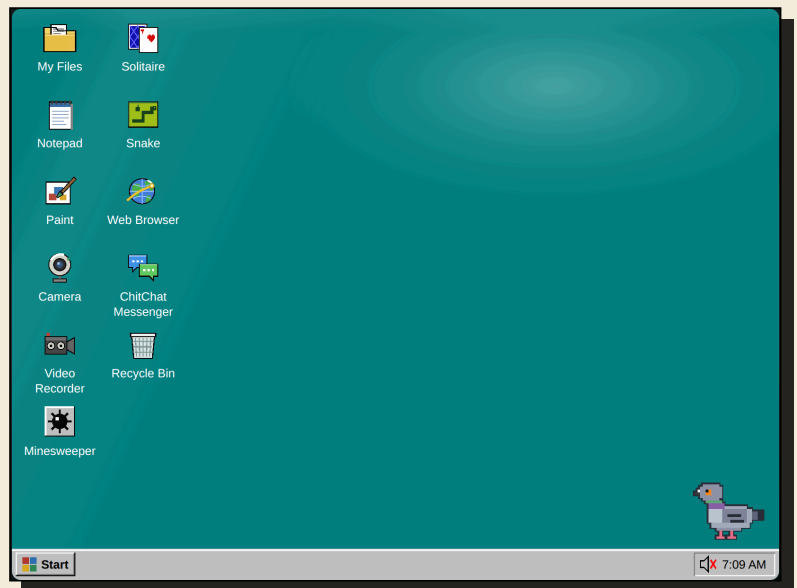
> 01 / START HERE.

PRESS THE POWER BUTTON.

ANACHRON is a make-believe computer from the 1990s that runs in your web browser: a beige CRT monitor, a teal desktop, windows you can drag, and apps that really work. Nothing to install, nothing to buy.

- 01** **Open the site** in Chrome, Firefox, Safari or Edge on a computer with a mouse and keyboard.
- 02** **Press the power button**, the small button at the bottom right of the monitor. The green light comes on.
- 03** **Watch it boot.** Memory, display, input and storage checks run, then a chime plays.
- 04** **Double-click an icon** to open an app, or click **Start** at the bottom left.

Everything stays on your computer. Files are kept in your browser's own storage. Nothing is uploaded, and no account is needed.



The desktop. App icons on the left, the taskbar along the bottom, Coo the pigeon in the corner.

> THE DESKTOP, IN SIX MOVES

WINDOWS

Drag by the title bar, resize from any edge or corner, minimize, maximize (or double-click the title bar) and close. Each window gets a taskbar button.

RECYCLE BIN

Deleted files wait here until you're sure. Drag a file onto the bin to delete it; open the bin to Restore or Delete for good.

CLOCK & CALENDAR

Point at the clock for the date; click it for a calendar. The speaker beside it turns all sound on or off.

RIGHT-CLICK

On a file: Open, Rename, Delete, Save to My Computer, Set as Wallpaper. On the empty desktop: Arrange Icons, Import Files, Properties.

DISPLAY PROPERTIES

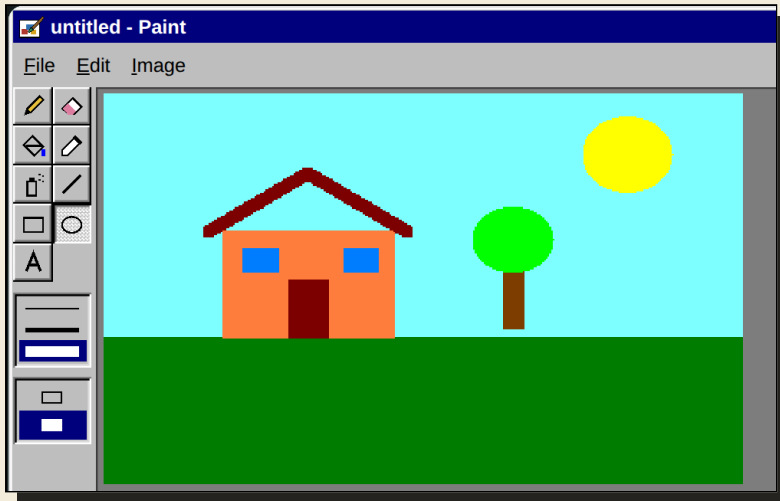
16 desktop colors, classic 8×8 patterns, and any saved picture as wallpaper, centered, tiled or stretched.

SAVING

Like a real computer: nothing is saved until you press **Ctrl** + **S** (**Cmd** + **S** on a Mac). Unsaved work? It asks first.

> 02 / MAKE THINGS

WRITE IT. DRAW IT. FILM IT.



Paint. Pencil, eraser, bucket, airbrush, lines, rectangles, ellipses and text, in 28 colors.



PAINT

Hold **Shift** for straight lines, squares and circles. The color picker takes a color from the picture; Image > Attributes changes its size up to 1000×1000. Saves PNG pictures.



NOTEPAD

Plain text with Find (**Ctrl** + **F**), Replace, Word Wrap and Time/Date. Saves .txt files to the desktop.



CAMERA

Your webcam, with chunky pixels. Take Picture, then save or Retake. Photos are exactly Paint-sized, so you can draw on them.



VIDEO RECORDER

Up to 60 seconds of webcam video with sound. Plays back straight away.

"IT LOOKS LIKE YOU'RE WRITING A LETTER."

Start a note with **"Dear"** and Coo the pigeon pops up to offer help, just like the office assistants of the nineties. (You can always say no.)



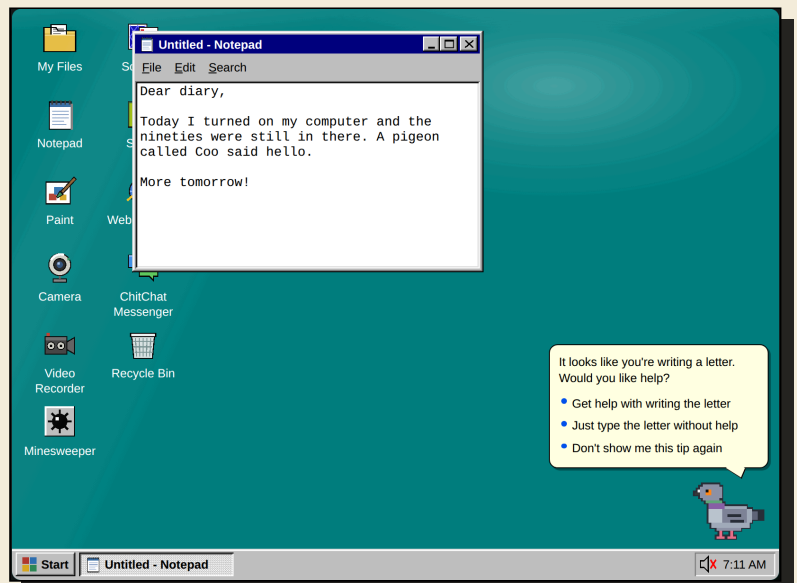
MY FILES

Every file with its type and size. Click a column title to sort.



OPEN ANYTHING

Text opens in Notepad, pictures in Image Viewer, videos in Video Player. Drag files in from your real computer, or right-click > Save to My Computer to take them out.



Notepad + Coo. Coo notices letters, first-time moments, and gives tips when clicked.

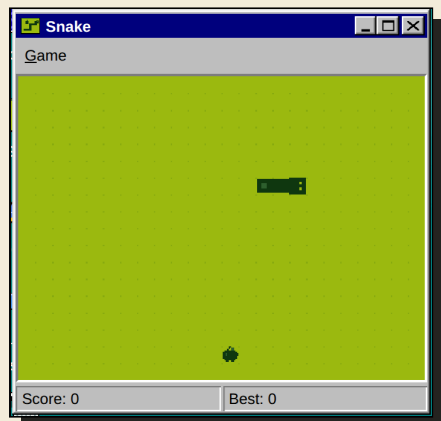
> 03 / PLAY_

THREE GAMES. NO QUARTERS.

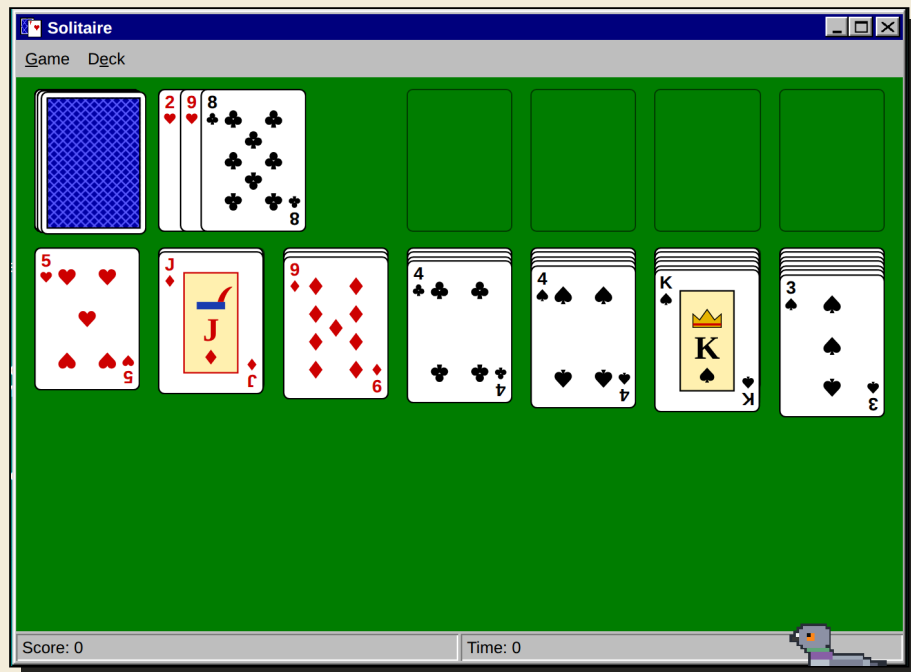
The classics that came with every PC, plus one from the handheld in your pocket. Press **N** (or **F2**) for a new game in any of them.



Minesweeper. Beginner, Intermediate, Expert.



Snake. Drag the window bigger for a bigger board.



Solitaire. Draw One or Draw Three, Undo, three card backs (one stars Coo).

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cards bounce off the table when you win, leaving trails behind them, exactly as you remember. Best times and scores are kept between visits.

MINESWEEPER

- Click a square to uncover it. A number counts the mines around it.
- Right-click to plant a flag.
- Your first click is always safe.
- Maximize for a bigger board.

SOLITAIRE

- Build four piles, Ace to King, one per suit.
- Below, stack down in alternating colors: red 9 on black 10.
- Double-click a card to send it home; right-click the table to send them all.

SNAKE

- Arrow keys or W A S D steer; swipe on a phone.
- Apples make you longer. Walls and your tail end it.
- **P** or **Space** pauses.
- Three speeds: 5, 10 or 20 points an apple.

> 04 / GO ONLINE_

DIAL UP THE WORLD WIDE WEB.

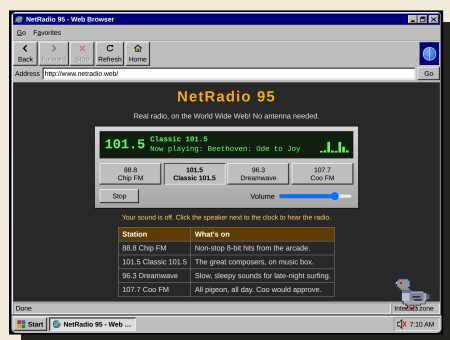
Open **Web Browser** and the modem dials, squeals and connects at 28,800 bps (press Skip if you can't wait). What you reach is a little web of sites that never existed, every address ending in .web.

Back, Forward, Stop, Refresh, Home and Favorites all work. Type a few words in the address box to search with **Seekr**. Real addresses get the classic *"The page cannot be displayed."*

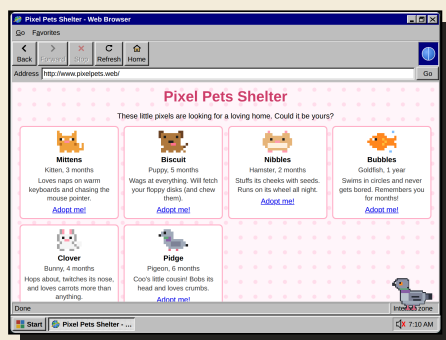
Nothing costs real money, nothing is sent anywhere. The radio's music is made as it plays.



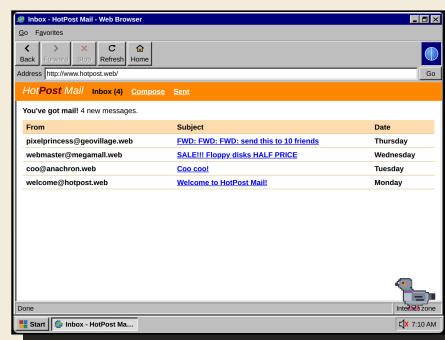
ANACHRON Home. A starry start page with every cool site.



NetRadio 95. Four stations.



Pixel Pets. Adopt one, keep it fed.



HotPost Mail. Coo writes back.

> THE DIRECTORY

Seekr

www.seekr.web

The search engine. Searches every page.

Mega Mall Online

www.megamall.web

Shop with a cart. Delivery in 6–8 weeks.

Cyber Cafe Chat

www.cybercafe.web

A chat room whose regulars talk back.

NetRadio 95

www.netradio.web

Chip FM, Classic 101.5, Dreamwave, Coo FM.

GeoVillage

www.geovillage.web

Homemade homepages: a cat, a band, dinosaurs.

Dial-Up Daily · Pixel Weather

dialup-daily.web · pixel-weather.web

The news, and a five-day forecast.

Webopedia

www.webopedia.web

Encyclopedia: modems, floppies, CRTs, pigeons...

HotPost Mail

www.hotpost.web

Web mail. Other addresses bounce.

Arcade Online

www.arcade-online.web

Tic-Tac-Toe and Guess the Number.

Pixel Pets Shelter

www.pixelpets.web

Feed, play, nap. It gets hungry while you're away.

Coo's Fan Club

www.coo-fan-club.web

Visitor counter and a guestbook to sign.

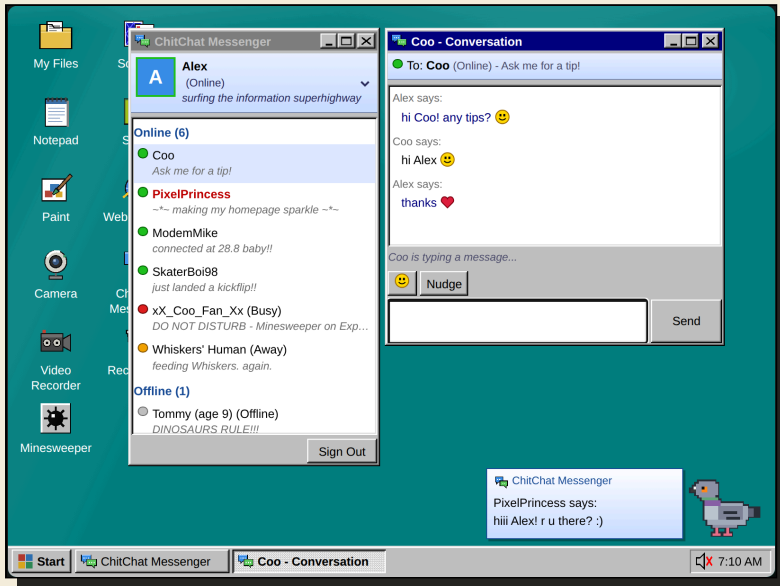
The Retro Webring

www.retro-ring.web

Hop from site to site, or pick at random.

> 05 / KEEP IN TOUCH

YOU'VE GOT A NUDGE.



ChitChat Messenger. Contact list, a conversation, and a pop-up from a friend.



COO, YOUR HELPER

Click Coo for a tip. Coo speaks up the first time you try something, can be dragged anywhere, and hides with a right-click (Start > Show Coo brings it back).

SOUND

A beep at power-on, a chime on the desktop, a goodbye at shut down, the modem's squeal, the radio. All made live by the browser, no sound files. The speaker by the clock mutes everything.

YOUR FILES

Kept in this browser, on this computer: they survive closing the page. Another browser won't see them, and clearing site data deletes them, so use **Save to My Computer** for anything precious.



CHITCHAT MESSENGER

Sign in with a name, a status (Online, Busy, Away, Appear Offline) and a personal message.

- Friends sign in with a pop-up and a chime.
- Double-click one to chat; watch them type.
- :) :D ;) <3 turn into little faces.
- **Nudge** shakes the window. They may nudge back.
- Busy keeps it quiet.

The friends are made up and answer by themselves. ANACHRON has no server, so nothing you type leaves your computer.

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Ctrl / Cmd + S	Save in Notepad, Paint, Camera, Recorder
Ctrl / Cmd + Z	Undo in Paint and Solitaire
Ctrl + F · F3	Find, find next in Notepad
Ctrl + E	Picture size in Paint
Shift + drag	Straight lines, squares, circles in Paint
N · F2	New game (F2 also renames a file)
P · Space	Pause Snake
F5 · Alt + ← →	Refresh, back, forward in Web Browser
Delete	Send the selected file to the Recycle Bin
Esc	Close a menu, the calendar or a dialog

C:\> SHUT DOWN

It is now safe to turn off your computer.